HOME REFERENCE

The Household Command Center

The facts you need when your brain is full.

Not a perfect home binder. A small, updateable place for the information future-you will need when the lights are flickering.

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01 A household-at-a-glance page
02 A fair-share task map
03 An emergency and pet-care sheet
04 A twelve-month home admin calendar
05 A secure paper and digital index

PLAIN ENGLISH ON PURPOSE

Print it. Write on it.
Make it yours.

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Build the hub before the hurry

Every household runs on invisible information: which bin goes out on Tuesday, who has the plumber's number, how the cat takes his medicine, where the lease is, what to do when the power goes out. Usually one person holds it in their head. That works until they are sick, away, overwhelmed, or simply tired of being the household's only search engine.

This is a reference, not a rulebook. It is designed to be filled in gradually and stored privately. You do not need to complete every page this week.

> WATCH OUT
>
> **Keep this private**
>
> A household hub can contain addresses, phone numbers, routines, and security details. Store it in a locked drawer, a private folder, or a secure location — not on a public fridge, in a shared cloud folder, or in a screenshot you text to someone. Never write passwords, PINs, security answers, or full financial account numbers on these pages.

What belongs here

- Household contacts and local services.
- Who does which recurring tasks, and who can back them up.
- Home basics: utilities, shutoffs, maintenance, and where the manual is.
- Emergency plans and meeting points.
- Pet and plant care.
- Annual renewals and home admin dates.
- Where important documents live — a map, not a copy of everything.

What does not belong here

- Passwords or password hints.
- Bank or card numbers.
- Government ID numbers.
- Full medical records.
- Anyone's private information beyond what is needed for the household to function.
- A complete list of every possession for insurance unless you store it securely elsewhere.

The update ritual

A household hub goes stale. Once a season, check the contacts, routines, and dates. Once a year, check the insurance, emergency plan, and document locations. Put those checks in the annual home admin calendar. An out-of-date hub is still better than none, as long as you know it needs a refresh.

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Household at a glance

Fill in what is useful. Use a nickname or a shared note instead of a full account number. If this page will be visible to a sitter or trusted visitor, remove anything private before leaving it out.

The basics

HOME	DETAILS
Address	
Main entrance / parking note	
Wi-Fi network name (not password)	
Where the router lives	
Trash and recycling day	
Where bins are kept	
Water shutoff location	
Electrical panel location	
Gas shutoff — who to call	
Smoke and carbon monoxide alarm test month	
Where the spare key is (not if it is not safe to record)	

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Key contacts

WHO	NAME	PHONE	WHEN TO CALL
Neighbour			
Landlord or property manager			
Plumber			
Electrician			
Heating / cooling			
Internet provider			
Insurance			
Vet			

House quirks

The door sticks. The extractor fan is loud. The guest bed is under the stairs. Write the things a visitor or future-you would not know.

The maintenance note

ITEM	LAST CHECKED	NEXT CHECK	WHO DOES IT

TRY THIS

Do not copy the whole house into one page

A hub is an index. If something is long — insurance policies, medical instructions, a lease — write where it lives and who to call, not the entire document again.

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Who does what

The mental load is not only the tasks you can see. It is noticing, planning, remembering, and reminding. A fair-share map makes those invisible tasks visible so they can be shared deliberately rather than argued about in a moment of exhaustion.

This is a practical household tool, not relationship advice. Use what helps and leave the rest.

The task map

TASK	HOW OFTEN	PRIMARY OWNER	BACKUP OWNER	WHERE THE INFO LIVES
Meal planning / food shop				
Cooking				
Dishes				
Laundry				
Cleaning shared spaces				
Trash and recycling				
Bills and mail				
Appointments				
Pet care				
Home repairs				
School or family admin				
Gifts and cards				

The noticing list

Some tasks begin with noticing, not doing. Examples: the soap is low, the fridge needs cleaning, a form is due, the pet food is almost gone. Who notices these things? Who acts on them? Who does the follow-up?

THE NOTICING TASK	WHO NOTICES	WHO ACTS	HOW WE SHARE THE LOAD

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The daily and weekly minimum

Agree on a small list that keeps the household functional — not spotless. A minimum is easier to maintain than an ideal.

- ☐ Food is available.
- ☐ Trash is out when needed.
- ☐ Dishes are not growing a community.
- ☐ Essential laundry is moving.
- ☐ Pets have food, water, and care.
- ☐ One shared surface is clear.
- ☐ Medication and appointments are handled by the person who owns them.

If the primary owner is away

Write down the things the backup would need to know: the grocery login? No. The store, the usual order, the pet routine, the school contact, the calendar. Keep it to information, not passwords.

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Emergency quick sheet

This page is a starting point for a household emergency plan. It is not a substitute for local emergency services or a doctor. Fill in your local numbers and check the plan with everyone who lives in the home.

WATCH OUT

Store this page safely

Do not leave a page with names, phone numbers, medical details, and security information in plain sight. Use a locked drawer or a private folder. If you make a version for a sitter, leave out anything they do not need.

In an emergency

01 Move to safety if you can.

02 Contact the local emergency number if there is immediate danger, a serious injury, fire, or a crime in progress.

03 Follow the instructions from emergency services.

04 Contact the household contact person when it is safe to do so.

05 Do not re-enter a dangerous building or try to fix a gas leak yourself.

The quick contacts

CONTACT	NAME	PHONE	NOTES
Emergency services			Local number
Non-emergency police			
Nearest hospital			
Poison control / health line			Local number
Household emergency contact			
Out-of-area contact			
Insurance emergency line			
Utility emergency line			
Vet emergency			
Building manager / landlord			

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The meeting place

WHERE WE MEET IF WE CANNOT GET BACK INSIDE | WHO CHECKS ON WHOM | WHERE THE EMERGENCY BAG LIVES

The emergency bag

- ☐ Water and a small snack.
- ☐ A flashlight and spare batteries.
- ☐ A phone charger or power bank.
- ☐ A copy of essential contacts.
- ☐ Any medication or supplies the household needs, following your own care plan.
- ☐ Pet supplies if applicable.
- ☐ A small amount of cash, if you choose to keep one.

Review the bag once a year. Replace expired items and check that the flashlight works.

What the sitter needs

Leave a short, separate page with the Wi-Fi guest access instructions only if you are comfortable, the pet routine, the emergency number, and any access details the sitter needs. Do not leave the full private hub on the counter.

The annual bag check

- ☐ Water and snacks are in date.
- ☐ The flashlight and batteries work.
- ☐ Contacts, medication, and pet supplies are current.
- ☐ Everyone knows where the bag lives.
- ☐ The meeting place is still sensible.

Date checked:

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Pets, plants, and the home-sitter page

A familiar routine is hard to explain from another city while your phone is dying. This page captures the practical care details, not the whole veterinary history.

The pet page

PET	FOOD AND TIMING	MEDICATION ROUTINE	VET AND PHONE	WHERE SUPPLIES ARE

The quirks

- The cat will not drink from the bowl next to the food.
- The dog is scared of the vacuum.
- The bird needs the cover on by 8 p.m.
- The fish tank light is on a timer.
- The pet is not allowed outside without a leash.
- The carrier is in the hall cupboard.

Write the things that matter to the animal and the sitter.

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The vet plan

QUESTION	ANSWER
Normal vet	
Emergency vet	
Insurance or payment note	
Who can approve treatment	
Where the records are	

The plant page

PLANT	WATER	LIGHT	NOTES

The sitter checklist

- ☐ Food and water locations are clear.
- ☐ The pet's routine is written down.
- ☐ The vet and emergency vet numbers are visible.
- ☐ The sitter knows what not to do.
- ☐ The alarm or key plan is agreed in advance.
- ☐ The sitter knows how to reach you and a backup.
- ☐ The trash and plant routine is clear.

> GOOD TO KNOW
>
> **Medical care for pets is still medical care**
>
> If a pet is injured or unwell, contact a veterinarian. This page helps with handover; it does not replace veterinary advice.

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The annual home admin calendar

Home admin is seasonal and repetitive. Put the recurring checks in one place, then let the calendar carry the remembering. Add local dates and requirements that apply to your home.

MONTH	HOME OR ADMIN TASK	WHO	DONE
January			☐
February			☐
March			☐
April			☐
May			☐
June			☐
July			☐
August			☐
September			☐
October			☐
November			☐
December			☐

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A starter list

Use what applies. Check official local guidance for anything safety-related.

- Test smoke and carbon monoxide alarms.
- Replace alarm batteries or backup batteries.
- Check the fire extinguisher.
- Clean or replace HVAC filters.
- Check the water shutoff and know how to use it.
- Check insurance renewal and coverage.
- Check vehicle registration or inspection dates.
- Review the emergency bag.
- Update the household hub.
- Back up important digital files.
- Clear the paper “act now” folder.
- Review subscriptions and annual renewals.

The safety rule

Do not attempt repairs or maintenance that requires a qualified professional, especially gas, electrical, structural, or anything you are not trained to do. The calendar can remind you; it cannot make a dangerous job safe. Use the official utility or a licensed tradesperson.

My home admin anchor

The one recurring day I will use to check this calendar:

The task I will put in the calendar first:

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The ten-minute household reset

This is maintenance, not a deep clean. The goal is to interrupt the drift before it becomes a project. Choose one zone and one timer. Stop when the timer ends.

The reset menu

Entryway

Shoes paired or put away, rubbish out, keys in their spot, one thing returned to its room. Stop there.

Kitchen

Clear one counter, load or unload the dishwasher, wipe one surface, take out the compost or bin if full. Do not reorganise the cupboards.

Bathroom

Clear the sink, replace the toilet roll, hang the towels, take out the bathroom bin. Stop before you start scrubbing the grout.

Bedroom

Clear the bed, put one pile of clothes away, take out one glass, plug in the phone. The floor can wait.

Living space

Clear one surface, fold one blanket, take out one cup, put remotes in their place. Do not start a full declutter.

Paper landing zone

Pick up one armful, sort into act / date / file / ask / release, stop at the timer. The full triage kit has the details.

The rule of one

When the house feels impossible, do not make a list of every room. Choose the one zone that is causing the most friction: the kitchen counter before dinner, the bed before sleep, the entryway before leaving. A little friction removed from the place you use most is worth more than a perfect room you never enter.

The reset log

DATE	ZONE	WHAT CHANGED	WHAT CAN WAIT

TRY THIS

A reset is not a debt payment

You do not have to clean the whole house because the last few weeks were hard. Ten minutes today is not compensation for the past. It is a small kindness to the next hour.

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Where the important things live

An index of important documents is more useful than a pile of unsorted papers and safer than a single folder with everything in it. Record where things live, who can find them, and when they were last checked.

The document index

WHAT	WHERE IT LIVES	IS IT BACKED UP?	WHO ELSE KNOWS?	LAST CHECKED
Lease or deed				
Home and car insurance				
Identification documents				
Wills, powers of attorney, advance directives				
Tax records				
Medical and vaccination records				
Pets' records				
Warranties and manuals				
Work and pension records				
Passwords / account recovery	Use a password manager, not this sheet			

The access plan

A password manager can store the credentials; this page can store only the name of the manager, where the recovery kit lives, and who is trusted to access it in a genuine emergency. Never write the master password here.

ACCESS QUESTION	ANSWER
Which password manager do we use?	
Where is the recovery kit kept?	
Who has a legitimate emergency key?	
Where is the emergency access plan documented?	
When was it last reviewed?	

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The digital backup check

- ☐ Important documents are backed up in more than one place.
- ☐ The backup is not only on the same device.
- ☐ The family knows how to access the backup if the primary person is unavailable.
- ☐ Recovery codes are stored securely, not in the same folder as the account.
- ☐ The plan has been checked in the last year.

The loss or theft page

If a wallet, phone, or documents are lost or stolen, use official provider websites and phone numbers. You may need to contact the police, your bank, the identity document issuer, and your insurer. Do not share passwords or one-time codes with anyone who contacts you claiming to help. Record the reference numbers somewhere secure.

My backup plan

WHAT	COPY ONE	COPY TWO	LAST CHECKED

My update check

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A small hub is enough

The household will not become calm because one binder exists. It may become a little easier because the plumber’s number is not in your head, because the pet routine is written down, and because the person who usually handles everything has somewhere to point.

The one-page takeaway

- Keep the hub private.
- Record where things live, not every private detail.
- Never write passwords or full account numbers.
- Make invisible tasks visible.
- Put annual checks in the calendar.
- Update the hub slowly; a partial hub is useful.

My next small step

GOOD TO KNOW

A final permission slip

A household does not need a perfect manager. It needs enough shared information that one tired person is not the only place the answers live.

ONE LAST THING · 12

Use one thing. Then keep it.

Fill in only the household basics today — names, key contacts, and where the important documents live. Store the finished pages somewhere private, not on a public fridge.

MY NEXT SMALL STEP

THE RULE FOR THIS HALF OF THE PACK

A system should fit your real energy, not the other way around. Keep what helps, drop what becomes another chore, and let the next small step be enough.

More life-admin printables

- 07 The Low-Energy Weekly Reset
- 08 The Paper Pile Triage Kit
- 09 Bills, Renewals & Subscriptions
- 10 The Appointment Companion
- 11 The Low-Energy Meal Plan

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Keep the useful part. Leave the rest.